

Evidence before allocation

Wharton investment competition | Working brief | 27 September 2026

Status: Local decision-support package prepared. Client-specific recommendation and competition submission blocked. AI-assisted draft for student verification and attribution.

Problem and audience

The student team needs a defensible way to translate the competition client's goals into liquidity, portfolio risk and investment decisions. The current workspace has research code and experiments, but lacks the official client case and verified trade records. This brief does not claim to know the client's needs.

Proposed value

Use a transparent process: extract the client's obligations, test whether they are affordable under downside assumptions, compare simple strategic allocations, and document why each approved holding serves a stated objective. Cash reserves are a candidate tool with an explicit opportunity cost. No target allocation is approved yet.

What the evidence supports

The earlier synthetic forecasting win was caused by leakage and was withdrawn. The repaired baseline study found no statistically supported advantage over the historical mean. Complex-model rankings and M11 funding claims remain unsupported. This supports caution about using those forecasts; it does not prove a strategic allocation or EWMA risk rule is optimal.

Usable local output

A separate cash-flow calculator compares three transparent policies across five assumed paths and five cost levels. Every input is labelled, every monthly cash movement is retained, and insolvency remains visible. It is a sensitivity tool, not a client forecast or a WInS record. The preparation pack adds written working responses, pitch content, a rehearsal script, evidence references and 60 judge questions.

Next decision

Supply the current Apply packet and client facts, then choose and justify an eligible portfolio. Add real WInS notes only after execution. Student review, source verification, AI attribution and explicit authorization precede submission. Public deadlines: roster October 9, trading notes October 23, IPS November 6, final report and school documentation December 4, each at 5 p.m. Eastern.

Sources: protocol/OFFICIAL_RULES_NOTE.md; runs/repaiRED/REPAIRED_RESULTS.json; audit/astra_2026-09-27/VERIFICATION.json; runs/competition_stress/RESULTS.json. Full links and limitations are in EVIDENCE_APPENDIX.md.